

Maria Alexis Sales

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Summary

Backend-focused software engineer with 4+ years building and owning resilient production systems across fintech, enterprise platforms, and AI infrastructure. Designs distributed, event-driven services around Kafka messaging and PostgreSQL storage, builds and optimizes REST APIs through root-cause analysis, and ships services on Docker and Kubernetes across AWS and Azure. Works in strongly-typed languages (Go, C#, C++, Java) with a product mindset focused on customer outcomes and data-informed decisions.

Skills

Languages: Go, C#, C/C++, Java, Python, TypeScript

Backend & Distributed Systems: Kafka, event-driven pipelines, REST APIs, OpenAPI, PostgreSQL, NestJS, Node.js

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (Lambda, API Gateway, EC2, S3), Azure, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD

Tools & Frontend: Datadog, Jenkins, Git, Perforce, React, Next.js

Experience

Software Engineer, USG Corporation – Hybrid

Sept 2025 – Present

- Built and optimized the NestJS backend powering the redesigned USG enterprise website (launched Dec 2025) — ~70–80% NestJS with a ~20% TypeScript/React/Next.js 15 frontend — as part of a broader platform migration.
- Root-caused a REST API bottleneck where Kafka messages hit the 2GB payload limit — used structured logging to trace it to an upstream parser injecting uncleaned fields, and partnered cross-team to resolve in ~2 hours.
- Re-architected Kafka data parsing through Prism (replacing a serialized string list with typed fields) and authored cleanup scripts to purge stale Algolia records after TTL expiry, hardening the distributed PostgreSQL → Kafka → Algolia pipeline end-to-end.
- Improved observability with Datadog to trace data sources and monitor stream processing across Azure file shares; applied Open API specs for contract-first versioning and instrumented pages with Adobe Analytics event tracking.

Software Engineer, Snorkel AI – Remote

June 2024 – Present

- Reviewed and validated AI-generated software engineering tasks derived from real open-source PRs, assessing correctness of problem statements, test cases, and solution artifacts against source material.
- Evaluated task quality for a coding-agent benchmark dataset (Harbor format), verifying Docker-based execution environments, test harnesses, and verifier reward logic against difficulty and language targets.

Software Developer I, Pacific Life – Newport Beach, CA

Sept 2024 – Nov 2024

- Designed a C# event-ingestion API for policyholder notifications (policy updates, coverage changes), publishing to Kafka for real-time, asynchronous delivery to policyholders and plan administrators in a regulated financial environment.
- Migrated legacy MuleSoft integrations to AWS Lambda and API Gateway, distributing execution across US East, West, and Central regions with S3-triggered load balancing for high-availability, concurrent file processing at scale.
- Built the document upload API in C# to route validated records to the correct insurance tier, completing the end-to-end flow from notification event to insurer delivery.

Associate Software Engineer, Blizzard Entertainment – Irvine, CA

Oct 2022 – Sept 2024

- Maintained and extended shared C# LiveOps tooling for Diablo II: Resurrected, integrating Nintendo, Sony, and Xbox console SDKs to route per-platform crash reports into an internal dashboard.
- Built a Python build-step tool that hash-checked locally compiled binaries against the latest Artifactory build and auto-pulled canonical binaries on mismatch, eliminating environment-drift bugs; maintained Jenkins CI/CD pipelines for multi-branch game development.

Projects

LiveOps Infrastructure Automation — Sunday Drivers (Volunteer)

2025

- Built quality-of-life and performance mods and integrated them into custom server deployments with GitHub Actions CI/CD; monitored stability and player feedback to deploy live hotfixes with minimal disruption.

Godot Gameplay Systems & Developer Tools — Inchworm Games (Volunteer)

2024

- Engineered modular C# gameplay systems and reusable UI components in the Godot Engine to accelerate development of internal prototypes and live features.

Education & Certifications

Stanford University & DeepLearning.ai – Machine Learning Specialization

2023

University of Illinois at Chicago – B.A. Music Performance; Minor, Computer Science

2021